

PART 8: DUNGEON MASTER INFORMATION

This section gives hints on how to handle character's special requests. It also includes expanded tables for lower dungeon levels, should the DM want to use random rolls to create dungeon encounters or treasure.

Also included is a step-by-step guide for creating a wilderness area, along with a sample wilderness that can be used as a guide or as part of a larger area. A suggested set of terrain symbols is included for use in wilderness mapping. Information on hiring specialists and building castles is presented, should characters want to set up their own territories.

Finally, this section contains tips on the Art of the DM, which may prevent some common problems in running a campaign, and make playing more fun for DM and player.

HANDLING PLAYER CHARACTERS

Player characters will often want to do actions not specifically covered in the rules or by their character descriptions. The DM should be prepared to handle such requests. A Dungeon Master must be flexible enough to be able to decide how to deal with situations that the rules don't cover. A good referee will think about how similar problems are handled in the rules, and then use a similar system. Some ideas on how to handle different situations are presented below.

SAVING VS. ABILITIES (OPTIONAL): The DM may want to base a character's chance of doing something on his or her ability ratings (Strength, etc.). The player must roll the ability rating or less on a d20. The DM may give a bonus or penalty to the roll, depending on the difficulty of the action (-4 for a simple task, +4 for a difficult one, etc.). It is suggested that a roll of 1 always succeed and a roll of 20 always fail.

SWIMMING: All characters may swim unless the DM decides otherwise. Movement rate while swimming is 1/2 normal. The DM will want to decide on the chance of a character drowning when swimming in rough water, swimming while carrying heavy or encumbering equipment or treasure, swimming while wearing heavy armor, or while fighting in the water. The chance of drowning will be largely dependent on the circumstances. For example, a fighter trying to swim in rough choppy seas while wearing plate armor and carrying 3000 cn of treasure might have a 99% chance of drowning. The same fighter in leather armor and not carrying treasure might have only a 10% chance of drowning. When fighting in the water or under the water, it should be harder to hit opponents, and damage done from successful attacks should be reduced. Missile weapons will not normally work while fighting in the water.

CLIMBING: Thieves (and only thieves) can climb steep surfaces, sheer walls, and slight overhangs by locating handholds not readily apparent to most characters and by using special climbing gear which only thieves know how to use. All characters, however, may climb obstacles such as trees, steep hills, or walls with handholds and footholds carved in them. All characters should have a chance of falling when climbing in a difficult situation, such as climbing a tree in a high wind, or climbing up a crumbling wall. A save against the character's Dexterity score is recommended (a successful save would be equal to or less than the character's Dexterity score). The DM should use good sense when deciding what may or may not be climbed.

FORAGING: Characters travelling in the wilderness may attempt to search or hunt for food, either to extend their normal supplies or prevent starvation. Searching for food may be done while traveling. If 1 is rolled on a d6, the party will have found enough to feed 1-6 men for one day. This food will consist of nuts, berries and possibly small game. To hunt, characters must spend a day without moving. There is a 1 in 6 chance of having an encounter from the Animal Subtable on the Wilderness Wandering Monster Tables. This encounter is in addition to any normal encounter rolls for the day. Days spent resting cannot be used for hunting.

Characters who run out of food may face a variety of circumstances that must be handled by the DM. Possible effects of hunger might include the need for more rest, slower movement rates, minuses "to hit", and gradual loss of hit points.

MAGICAL RESEARCH AND PRODUCTION

As mentioned in the information concerning clerics, elves, and magic-users, these classes may attempt to research new spells and create new magical items. These are difficult and lengthy projects for the characters and the DM must handle such attempts with judgment and care.

Spell Research. New spells may be researched by any spell caster. Research requires both money and time spent out of the campaign.

To research a spell, the new spell must be written out and given to the DM, who decides if it is possible, what level it should be, and what changes are needed for play balance. A player may not research spells higher than his character can cast. Spell research costs 1,000 gp per level and requires 2 weeks of research per level.

Producing Magic Items. On reaching name level, clerics may try to make any item usable by clerics (including items that duplicate the effects of clerical spells), while magic-users and elves can attempt to create any item *except* those items usable only by clerics. The DM may limit or forbid the production of certain powerful items.

To create a magic item, the spell caster must first gather together the rare materials from which the item will be made. The DM should decide what is necessary to make different items. A scroll might require special parchment and a different formula of ink for each spell effect. Weapons might require rare metals, powdered gems forged into the metal, or the blood or skins of creatures which are to be affected by the weapon. These items should be difficult to obtain, and the spell caster will often have to adventure to acquire the items, for there are no magic stores. Then the spell caster must spend time and money fashioning the item and enchanting it. The spell caster may *not* go adventuring during the time it takes to create a magic item.

Creating items that duplicate a spell effect once usually requires 500 gp and 1 week *per* spell level.

Examples	Cost	Time
Scroll: 2x magic missile *	1000	2 weeks
potion of healing	500	1 week
fire ball wand	30,000	4 months (120 days)
* (3 missiles ea.)		
** (fully charged with 20 charges)		

There is always a 15% chance (at least) that magical research or production will fail. This check is made after the time and money are spent.